3 *The Test*

So the ships were brought into the dock and the passengers began to go ashore. But Mr Escombe had sent word to the captain that, as the whites were highly enraged against me and my life was in danger, my family and I should be advised to land at dusk, when the Port Superintendent Mr Tatum would escort us home. The captain communicated the message to me, and I agreed to act accordingly. But scarcely half an hour after this Mr Laughton came to the captain. He said: 'I would like to take Mr Gandhi with me, should he have no objection. As the legal adviser of the Agent Company I tell you that you are not bound to carry out the message you have received from Mr Escombe.' After this he came to me and said somewhat to this effect: 'If you are not afraid, I suggest that Mrs Gandhi and the children should drive to Mr Rustomji's house, whilst you and I follow them on foot. I do not at all like the idea of your entering the city like a thief in the night. I do not think there is any fear of anyone hurting you. Everything is quiet now. The whites have all dispersed. But in any case I am convinced that you ought not to enter the city stealthily.' I readily agreed. My wife and children drove safely to Mr Rustomji's place. With the captain's permission I went ashore with Mr Laughton. Mr Rustomji's house was about two miles from the dock.

As soon as we landed, some youngsters recognized me and shouted, 'Gandhi, Gandhi.' About half a dozen men rushed to the spot and joined in the shouting. Mr Laughton feared that the